



Based in San Francisco



EDUCATION

BSC ELECTRICAL & COMPUTER ENGINEERING

2016 – 2019 · University of Cape Town

- Graduated with First Class Honours as the top BSc(Eng) student.
- Awarded the prize for the best final-year thesis.

SKILLS

LANGUAGES & TOOLS

Go, Python, SQL, Git, Docker, gRPC

DOMAINS

Distributed systems · P2P networks · protocol design · database migrations · code review at scale

Elle Mouton

Backend Software Engineer

ABOUT

Backend engineer with 5+ years building production-scale distributed systems. My work spans event-driven microservices serving millions of users and protocol-level upgrades to large, live peer-to-peer networks. I thrive in small, fast-moving teams with high ownership and high engineering standards.

Especially interested in developer tools, AI, and event-driven systems.

EXPERIENCE

⚡ Lightning Infrastructure Engineer | Lightning Labs

2021 – Present

One of the top contributors to [LND](#), the most widely-deployed Lightning Network implementation. My work centres on shipping protocol upgrades and large database migrations safely across a live peer-to-peer network of thousands of nodes. I also lead major features in the Lightning Terminal and Lightning Node Connect developer-tooling projects.

- Contributions to the Lightning Network protocol specification.
- Significant optimisations to the Neutrino (Bitcoin light-client) sync process.
- Extensive code review on a large, widely-used open-source codebase.

🔵 Software Engineer | Luno

2020 – 2021

Backend engineer on the crypto-operations team. Worked in Go on event-driven microservices handling high cryptocurrency volumes for millions of users.

PUBLIC APPEARANCES



Advancing Bitcoin,
London (2022)



Connect The World
Podcast (2022)



The Chaincode Podcast
(2023)



Bitcoin Optech Podcast
(Jul 2024)



Bitcoin Optech Podcast
(Oct 2024)



Bitcoin++ Brazil (2025)

WRITING

Deep-dive technical posts on Bitcoin and Lightning Network internals, widely read across the community. ellemouton.com/articles →